TURNING POINTS IN THE CREATOR ECONOMY

FEBRUARY 2005
↘ Launch of YouTube; Google acquires it next year. India launch in 2008

2010
↘ The Viral Fever (TVF) starts a YouTube channel. Its spoofs and sketches garner millions of views, making it one of the first Indian success stories

2014-15
↘ Video-sharing app Dubsmash launches. Users share clips of them lip-syncing and acting to songs and dialogues

↘ India's first wave of content creators emerges, with CarryMinati, Bhuvan Bam, Ashish Chanchlani, Prajakta Koli aka Mostly-Sane and BeYouNick striking a chord with the youth

SEPTEMBER 2016
↘ Jio launches its 4G broadband service, giving millions access to the internet for free. The same month, TikTok launches in India

AUGUST 2020
↘ Instagram launches Reel, enabling its users to share short video content; the next month, YouTube joins the 'small is good' bandwagon with its own feature, Shorts

MARCH 2024
↘ A month before the general election, the Union ministry of electronics and IT hosts the National Creator Awards. Prime Minister Narendra Modi awards creators like Ranveer Allahbadia aka BeerBiceps

BADUSHA P.T.



Working-Class Hero

KL BRO BIJU, *38*
KL BRO BIJU RITHVIK
KANNUR, **KERALA**

72.7 MILLION subscribers
1.2 MILLION followers

Biju has seen life from the hard angles—as a labourer at a quarry, as a helper in a lorry and, later, as a mini truck and jeep driver. Rendered jobless during the pandemic and stranded at home, he decided, on a whim, to shoot videos on a Samsung phone bought with money a friend gave him.

His first YouTube video, uploaded in 2021, was about a young man's hunt for a bride in neighbouring state Karnataka. That video became a viral hit. He has not looked back since. His videos, in which only Malayalam is spoken, are centred around simple, workaday domestic activities or, say, a short trip, that features his family—wife Kavitha (28), mother